Hadi Metlej

Penetration Tester | Web, API & Network Security
Dubai, United Arab Emirates

Portfolio: Hadi Metlej | Offensive Security

Phone Number: +971588043090

Professional Summary

Penetration tester with 2 years of hands-on experience in web, API, and infrastructure security testing gained through professional engagements, bug bounty research, CTF practice, and the development of cybersecurity training labs. Skilled in identifying and exploiting business logic and authorization vulnerabilities, SSRF, race conditions, deserialization, remote code execution, and other advanced web vulnerabilities. Currently preparing for the Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) exam scheduled in April 2026.

Completed 70+ hands-on security labs and participated in CTF competitions, ranking 28th among 1,100 participants in a nationwide CTF event.

Experience

Penetration Tester — Traveln.ai Feb 2025 – Present | Dubai, United Arab Emirates

- Conducted web, API, and infrastructure penetration testing focusing on business logic and authorization vulnerabilities
- Identified high-impact business logic flaws leading to unauthorized booking and revenue-impact scenarios
- Discovered and validated multiple authorization vulnerabilities including IDOR and access control bypass.
- Assessed CSRF, parameter tampering, and backend validation weaknesses to determine real-world exploitability and security impact.
- Performed security testing on AI-powered features, identifying logic flaws in LLM-integrated systems
- Conducted web, API, and infrastructure penetration testing using tools such as Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, and manual testing techniques.

Penetration Tester Intern — Traveln.ai Nov 2024 – Jan 2025 | Dubai, United Arab Emirates

- Conducted web application and infrastructure security testing independently.
- Identified and validated vulnerabilities and contributed to security findings and reporting.

Security Researcher — Bug Bounty & Responsible Disclosure — HackerOne Jan 2025 – Present

- Conducted vulnerability research across public bug bounty programs.
- Reported security issues including SSRF primitives, race condition vulnerabilities, and AI assistant trust-boundary flaws.
- Demonstrated a race condition in OTP verification and resend flows enabling rate-limit bypass, OTP flooding, and potential SMS cost amplification.
- Submitted detailed technical reports including PoC, reproduction steps, and security impact analysis.

Security Labs & CTF Practice May 2024 – Present

- Completed over 70 hands-on labs covering web exploitation, network attacks, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation techniques via CTF platforms and personal lab setups. Ranked 28th out of 1,100 participants in a nationwide CTF competition, solving complex challenges across web, crypto and infrastructure categories.

Projects

Zekrion Cyber Security Lab Platform — Founder & Developer (In Development)
Aug 2025 – Present

- Developing a cybersecurity training platform designed to simulate real-world offensive and defensive security environments.
  Currently building a web exploitation lab covering over 70 vulnerability and attack scenarios, including SQL injection, SSRF, race conditions, authentication bypass, deserialization and remote code execution.
  Designing multi-level vulnerability labs (low / medium / high) to simulate realistic attack complexity and skill progression.
  Implementing modular lab deployments for Active Directory, infrastructure auditing, cloud security and CI/CD pipeline security.
  Hosting the platform on AWS infrastructure with orchestrated lab containers; planned future phases include cloud labs, defensive scenarios and collaboration with cybersecurity professionals.

Certifications

- Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) – Exam scheduled April 2026
- eJPTv2 – eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester (INE Security)
- AWS Certified Security – Specialty (SCS-C02)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03)
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02)
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA 200-301)

Technical Skills

Web & Application Security

- SQL Injection, Cross-Site Scripting (XSS), Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF), Clickjacking, DOM-based vulnerabilities, path traversal, local file inclusion (LFI), file upload vulnerabilities, access control vulnerabilities, authentication & authorization issues.

Advanced Web & Protocol Attacks

- Server-Side Request Forgery (SSRF), XML External Entity (XXE), HTTP request smuggling, HTTP host header attacks, web cache poisoning, web cache deception, CORS misconfigurations, server-side template injection (SSTI), insecure deserialization, remote code execution (RCE).

Identity & Modern Web Security

- JSON Web Tokens (JWT), OAuth authentication, WebSockets security, Web LLM security.

Network & Infrastructure Security

- Active Directory enumeration (learning), Active Directory attacks (learning), privilege escalation (Linux/Windows), network service enumeration.

Exploitation

- OS command injection, buffer overflow exploitation (learning), post-exploitation techniques.

Tools

- Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, SQLMap, Wfuzz, Nikto, Hydra, Nessus, Wireshark, BloodHound, Turbo Intruder.

Operating Systems & Scripting

- Linux, Windows, Powersell, Bash, Python.

Currently Learning

- Active Directory attacks, buffer overflow exploitation, API security testing (REST & GraphQL), NoSQL injection, prototype pollution.